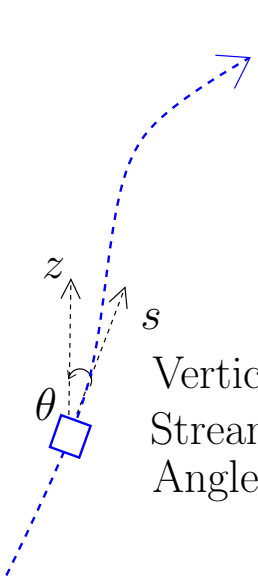
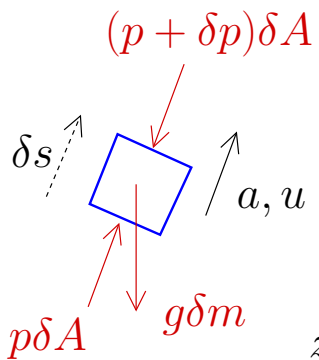
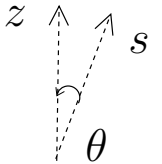


Vertical coordinate z
Streamwise coordinate s
Angle between them θ





$\cos\theta = \partial z/\partial s$